

D297

Designing E-Learning Experiences for Adults

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Nurses in an online leadership course, offered by a hospital with a new wing, complain that the first module is a long history of management theory with no tie to their shifts. Most have over ten years of experience. What redesign best fits andragogy?

- A. Show a tour of the new wing.
- B. Add a quiz on management history to boost motivation.
- C. Open with a real staffing problem from their units, explain why the skill matters, and draw on their experience.
- D. Treat all learners as beginners.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

In a course for new retail managers, run on a sleek mobile app, learners handle a simulated customer complaint, then write what happened and how they felt. Which stage should come next in Kolb's cycle?

- A. Abstract conceptualization: link their reflections to a de-escalation model.
- B. Active experimentation right away.
- C. Another concrete experience with no reflection.
- D. Redesign the app interface.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Learners have studied a coaching model and now try it in a real conversation with a team member. Which stage is this?

- A. Concrete experience only, with no model involved.
- B. Active experimentation.
- C. Abstract conceptualization.
- D. Reflective observation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A veteran manager in a diversity course hosted on a well-designed platform learns that her hiring choices have consistently excluded certain candidates, which clashes with how she sees herself. Which design step best supports transformative learning?

- A. Give her a list of hiring laws to memorize.
- B. Tell her the finding does not matter.
- C. Praise the platform's design.
- D. Guide her in critically reflecting on her assumptions and discussing them with peers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which outcome best shows transformative learning, rather than informational learning?

- A. Every completed course is transformative.
- B. A supervisor learns a new software feature.
- C. A supervisor now sees employee mistakes as system problems, changing how she leads.
- D. A supervisor memorizes five new policies.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A company with offices in six cities adds an optional discussion board to its engineering training. After three months, almost no one posts. The board has a modern design. What change would best build a community of practice?

- A. Require 6 posts per week from everyone.
- B. Organize monthly case-sharing threads on real project problems, with peer facilitators and a shared goal.
- C. Wait longer for posts to grow.
- D. Redesign the board's look.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An online supply-chain course, taught by an instructor with a famous textbook, gives six weeks of lectures and then a final case study. The designers call it problem-based learning. What would make it true PBL?

- A. Add a second case study at the end.
- B. Give all the answers before the problem.
- C. Use the famous textbook more.
- D. Start with a messy, real supply-chain problem that learners investigate, with the instructor facilitating.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a PBL course, a learner asks the instructor for the right answer to the case. What should the instructor do?

- A. Assign a lecture on the answer.
- B. Say nothing at all.
- C. Give the answer to save time.
- D. Ask guiding questions that help the learner decide what to research next.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

In a competency-based accounting-software course at a firm with a strong training budget, a bookkeeper with 15 years of experience must complete all 20 hours before the final assessment. What design change fits competency-based principles?

- A. Let learners take a pre-assessment and skip competencies they already show.
- B. Require all 20 hours to be fair.
- C. Shorten the course to 15 hours for everyone.
- D. Spend more of the training budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

After a well-produced online safety course, 95% of warehouse staff passed the quiz, yet supervisors see little change on the floor. The course was filmed in a studio. What change most improves transfer?

- A.** Add practice with job-like scenarios, spaced refreshers, job aids, and supervisor follow-up.
- B.** Assume the quiz shows they will use the skill.
- C.** Refilm in a nicer studio.
- D.** Raise the passing score above 95%.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A community college with a modern campus offers a career-change program only on weekday mornings. Many working adults say they cannot attend at those times. What type of barrier is this?

- A.** Situational.
- B.** Institutional.
- C.** Dispositional.
- D.** Campus facilities.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An adult says, "I'm too old to learn computers; I'd just embarrass myself." Which barrier is this, and what design response fits?

- A.** No barrier; adults never lack confidence.
- B.** Institutional; change the class schedule.
- C.** Dispositional; start with early, low-risk wins and supportive feedback.
- D.** Situational; offer childcare.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

Nurses in an online leadership course, ~~offered by a hospital with a new wing~~, complain that the first module is a long history of management theory with no tie to their shifts. Most have over ten years of experience. What redesign best fits andragogy?

Target word: adult-learning fix **Decides:** Content lacks relevance to their roles and ignores experience.

A	Camouflage	Unrelated to learning.
B	Inverted operation	Adds more of the unconnected content.
C	Correct	Problem-centered, relevant, and builds on experience.
D	Dropped element	Ignores their experience.

2. Answer A Concept 2

In a course for new retail managers, ~~run on a sleek mobile app~~, learners handle a simulated customer complaint, then write what happened and how they felt. Which stage should come next in Kolb's cycle?

Target word: next stage **Decides:** Experience and reflection are done.

A	Correct	Follows reflective observation.
B	Dropped element	Skips forming concepts.
C	Inverted operation	Loops back without learning from the first.
D	Camouflage	Not part of the cycle.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

Learners have studied a coaching model and now try it in a real conversation with a team member. Which stage is this?

Target word: name the stage from the activity **Decides:** Applying the model in practice.

A	Adjacent category	They are applying a model, which is experimentation.
B	Correct	Trying out the concept in a real situation.
C	Inverted operation	That was studying the model.
D	Confusion set	Reflecting on an experience.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A veteran manager in a diversity course ~~hosted on a well-designed platform~~ learns that her hiring choices have consistently excluded certain candidates, which clashes with how she sees herself. Which design step best supports transformative learning?

Target word: support transformation **Decides:** Disorienting dilemma present; needs critical reflection.

A	Adjacent category	Adds facts but does not examine assumptions.
B	Inverted operation	Dismisses the dilemma.
C	Camouflage	Unrelated.
D	Correct	Critical reflection and dialogue drive transformation.

5. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

Which outcome best shows transformative learning, rather than informational learning?

Target word: recognize transformation **Decides:** A changed frame of reference.

A	Absolute language	Most learning is informational.
B	Adjacent category	A new skill.
C	Correct	A shift in underlying perspective.
D	Confusion set	New information, not a changed perspective.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A company with offices in six cities adds an optional discussion board to its engineering training. After three months, almost no one posts. ~~The board has a modern design.~~ What change would best build a community of practice?

Target word: build a community of practice **Decides:** No shared purpose or structure.

A	Wrong stem number	Forced quotas do not build shared practice.
B	Correct	Gives purpose, structure, and a reason to contribute.
C	Dropped element	Nothing changes.
D	Camouflage	Design is not the barrier.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An online supply-chain course, ~~taught by an instructor with a famous textbook~~, gives six weeks of lectures and then a final case study. The designers call it problem-based learning. What would make it true PBL?

Target word: what PBL requires **Decides:** The problem must come first and drive learning.

A	Adjacent category	Still content first.
B	Inverted operation	Removes inquiry.
C	Camouflage	Unrelated to the PBL structure.
D	Correct	PBL begins with the problem.

8. Answer D Concept 5 · transfer

In a PBL course, a learner asks the instructor for the right answer to the case. What should the instructor do?

Target word: instructor's role **Decides:** Instructor facilitates.

A	Adjacent category	Returns to direct teaching.
B	Absolute language	Facilitation still guides.
C	Inverted operation	Takes over learners' inquiry.
D	Correct	Facilitates without giving the answer.

9. Answer A Concept 6

In a competency-based accounting-software course ~~at a firm with a strong training budget~~, a bookkeeper with 15 years of experience must complete all 20 hours before the final assessment. What design change fits competency-based principles?

Target word: competency-based design **Decides:** Experience is not being credited.

A	Correct	Mastery, not seat time, sets the path.
B	Absolute language	Equal time is not the goal.
C	Wrong stem number	Still time-based.
D	Camouflage	Budget does not fix the design.

10. Answer A Concept 7

After a well-produced online safety course, 95% of warehouse staff passed the quiz, yet supervisors see little change on the floor. ~~The course was filmed in a studio.~~ What change most improves transfer?

Target word: improving transfer **Decides:** High quiz scores, low on-the-job use.

A	Correct	Realistic practice and support drive transfer.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the job-behavior gap.
C	Camouflage	The studio detail does not decide transfer.
D	Wrong stem number	Quiz scores are not the issue.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A community college ~~with a modern campus~~ offers a career-change program only on weekday mornings. Many working adults say they cannot attend at those times. What type of barrier is this?

Target word: classify the barrier **Decides:** The provider's scheduling policy.

A	Confusion set	Situational barriers come from life circumstances.
B	Correct	Caused by the provider's schedule.
C	Confusion set	Dispositional barriers are the learner's attitudes.
D	Camouflage	Not the barrier described.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

An adult says, "I'm too old to learn computers; I'd just embarrass myself." Which barrier is this, and what design response fits?

Target word: classify and respond **Decides:** The barrier is an attitude.

A	Absolute language	Dispositional barriers are common.
B	Inverted operation	The provider's policies are not the cause.
C	Correct	Builds confidence to address attitude.
D	Confusion set	No life-circumstance barrier named.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Andragogy	Adults want to know why they are learning, bring experience to build on, are ready to learn what their roles demand, prefer problem-centered learning, and respond to internal motivation.	Designing adult courses like school lessons with abstract content and no link to their work.	Adult learners disengaging from content they see no use for.
2	Kolb's experiential learning cycle	Learning moves through concrete experience, reflective observation, abstract conceptualization, and active experimentation.	Assuming experience alone teaches, without reflection and trying again.	A sequence of activities and a question about the missing or next stage.
3	Transformative learning	Transformation begins with a disorienting dilemma and grows through critical reflection on one's assumptions and dialogue with others, leading to a changed perspective.	Treating transformation as gaining new facts or skills.	A learner whose beliefs are challenged and a question about the process.
4	Collaborative learning and communities of practice	Adults learn by sharing practice with peers around a shared domain; design gives structure, shared goals, and a reason to contribute.	Adding an optional discussion board and expecting a community to form.	A peer-learning space with little participation.
5	Problem-based learning	PBL presents an ill-structured, realistic problem first; learners identify what they need to learn, research it, and propose solutions, with the instructor as facilitator.	Teaching all the content first and calling the final case study PBL.	The order of problem and content, and the instructor's role.
6	Competency-based design for adults	Define competencies, let learners show what they already know to skip ahead, and let pacing follow mastery rather than a fixed calendar.	Making experienced adults sit through content they have already mastered.	Experienced learners forced through the full course.
7	Designing for transfer	Transfer to the job improves when practice mirrors real tasks and settings, is spaced over time, and is supported afterward by job aids and manager follow-up.	Assuming passing an end-of-course quiz means people will use the skill at work.	Good course scores but little change on the job.
8	Barriers to adult participation	Situational barriers come from life circumstances (time, family, cost); institutional barriers come from the provider's policies and schedules; dispositional barriers are the learner's own attitudes and confidence.	Mixing up institutional and situational barriers.	A reason adults give for not enrolling or finishing.

Course scope (public description): Designing E-Learning Experiences for Adults is the first of two courses in the adult learning designer pathway. This course teaches best practices for supporting adult learners as they acquire knowledge and learn new skills and dispositions. This course explains effective approaches to designing learning experiences for adult learners that are collaborative, experiential, and transformative in nature. This course also explores problem-based and competency-based approaches to designing learning experiences for adults. Each evidence-based approach is defined and supported by theory and research. The course also includes best practices for designing each type of learning experience and provides real examples of each approach. Learning Technology is a prerequisite for this course.